Scribes Writers – January, '07 Word count:805
Estelle El-Hai

THE UNSUITABLE SUITOR

A well meaning acquaintance from the Jewish Fellowship Club, who is several years younger than I, called me to ask permission to give my phone number to a Lincoln Hills resident she had recently met. She described him as attractive but a bit too old for her. He was interested in meeting a lively woman with whom he could develop a friendship. After further inquiry, I learned that the gentleman was four years older than I and born in Canada. I gave my permission, and after a pleasant phone conversation with him, I agreed to have coffee with "Gordon" at the Lodge.

I impulsively called Gordon "Flash", and told him he would recognize me by the flower I was carrying. He, in turn, said he would be wearing tan slacks and a black shirt. The flower I selected was a sparkly poinsettia, and initially, I planned to plant it on my head. But I remembered that Flash admitted that he was a little shy so I scratched that idea. I arrived early so that I could select a place with flattering light, and discovered that I was the only one in the entry area. After a few minutes, a handsome man in tan slacks and a black shirt walked slowly by. I awarded him with a beaming Crest smile.

"Is it you?" I inquired demurely.
"It sure is." he answered. "Are you You?"
"Flash?" I questioned.
"I'd rather not", he confessed. "Why do you ask?"

This did not sound like a shy guy, so I asked for his name. It turned out to be Steve and I admitted that I had made an embarrassing mistake. Flash arrived a few minutes later and we strolled (slowly) to the restaurant.

The election had taken place a few days before, and I asked him if he was pleased with the results.

"I don't like to discuss politics because it can start arguments." he stated.

"A spirited discussion can help us get better acquainted." I offered.

I then gave him one of my hand painted magnetic book marks. "Here's a surprise for you. It's museum quality."

"I don't like to read books because I get restless." he explained.

"Then, it's not for you." I said as I withdrew my gift.

"Oh no, I want to show my children what my new lady friend made." he said as he retrieved the artwork.

Changing the subject, I offered to tell his fortune and asked for his hand so that I could view his palm. I sympathize with the fact that many people have poor circulation and therefore, cold extremities. His hands were not only ice cold but soft and smooth, like a woman's. Evidently, he didn't use them often and I found that a big negative. I gave him a pleasant reading just the same.

Talking about his children should be on safe grounds. I learned that they selected his dwelling at Sun City Lincoln, and also buy his clothing for him at the most expensive stores. They also manage his money for him, so he has little to do. Very little! Thunder Valley was his main source of entertainment.

As the restaurant filled up, the background noise made it difficult to continue our conversation. I suggested sitting in the lounge. He requested that he take a peek at some family pictures in my home. Noting my hesitation, he insisted that he was not Jack the Ripper, or Jack the Raper. Remembering that my acquaintance told me that he was indeed a gentleman, I reluctantly said, "OK, but just for a few minutes." Actually, that decision turned out to be a problem solver.

When we arrived, I showed him the family photos on the wall. His eyes scanned the many paintings and glasswork. "Boy, you sure spend a lot of money on art." he pondered.

"Not really," I answered, "That's one hobby that keeps me happy and busy."

"You probably don't have much time for anything else." he concluded.

"On the contrary, I have jillions of activities that I look forward to. There aren't enough hours in the day."

"What else keeps you so busy?"

I truthfully explained my interest in writing, acting, singing, water aerobics, cooking, stimulating conversations, etc. etc.

The poor man was intimidated and said, "You don't have room in your life for a man."

"But I always had many interests and shared it with my husband and children."

As he left, I averted his intended kiss and offered my cheek. This was a mis-match big time, and I'm so glad that I'm so glad. Hopefully, Flash will find a simple little lady, who enjoys watching TV and playing the slots, who won't think he's just a flash in the pan.

*** finis ***